

## Site Build Process Summary

### Goal

Use this checklist the next time you build a site so the project starts clean, stays organized, and deploys without the common mistakes we hit this time.

#### 1. Start With The Right Structure

- Pick the stack first.
- For a React site with Node.js, Vite is a good default.
- Create the app structure before moving page code into it.
- Keep pages in src/pages.
- Keep shared hooks in src/hooks.
- Keep shared styles in src/styles.css.
- Keep routing in src/App.jsx.

#### 2. Set Up The Project Correctly

- Create package.json with clear scripts:
- npm run dev
- npm run build
- npm run preview
- Add vite.config.js.
- Add index.html.
- Add src/main.jsx.
- Add vercel.json if the site uses React Router and needs rewrites.

#### 3. Add Git Protection Early

Create .gitignore before the first big commit.

Always ignore:

- node\_modules/
- dist/
- .vercel/
- .env\*
- editor or OS junk

This prevents deployment failures and huge bad commits.

#### 4. Move Page Code Carefully

- Put each page in src/pages.
- Fix imports after moving files.
- Make sure all pages use the same storage approach.
- If you use local storage, all pages should use the same hook like useLocalStorage.
- Avoid mixing storage patterns unless you really need to.

#### 5. Build Shared App Features Once

Set up these shared pieces early:

- routing
- navigation
- homepage
- shared card/table styles
- shared form styles
- shared storage hook

This avoids repeating code in every page.

#### 6. Verify Before Deploying

Run these locally:

```
“bash
npm install
npm run build
“
```

If build fails, fix local errors before pushing.

A successful local build is the best pre-deployment check.

#### 7. Deployment Rules For Vercel

- Vercel should install dependencies itself.
- Never commit node\_modules/.
- Never commit dist/.
- Keep build command as npm run build.
- Keep output directory as dist.
- Add rewrite support for React Router using vercel.json.

## 8. Safe Git Workflow

Recommended flow:

```
'bash
git status
git add .
git commit -m "Describe the change clearly"
git push
'
```

Before pushing, confirm:

- no accidental generated files are tracked
- no secrets are committed
- the build passes

## 9. Common Mistakes To Avoid

- starting from loose JSX files without a real app scaffold
- committing node\_modules
- committing dist
- mixing multiple storage systems by accident
- deploying before running npm run build
- forgetting route rewrites on Vercel
- leaving page-specific styles unsupported by the global stylesheet

## 10. Best Order Next Time

Follow this order:

1. Create Vite app structure.
2. Add .gitignore.
3. Add routing and shared layout.
4. Add shared storage hook.
5. Move page files into src/pages.
6. Fix imports and shared styles.
7. Run npm install.
8. Run npm run build.
9. Commit only source files and config.
10. Push to GitHub.

11. Deploy to Vercel.

## 11. Final Quick Checklist

- Project scaffold exists
- .gitignore exists
- Pages are in src/pages
- Shared hook is consistent
- App builds locally
- node\_modules is not tracked
- dist' is not tracked
- GitHub repo is clean
- Vercel settings are correct

## Short Rule

Build first, verify locally, commit only source code, then deploy.